Murshid – Full Blueprint

Every athlete has a manager. Now every student does too.

10 October 2026

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Executive summary

The product. One AI agent per student, built around their identity and goals. Behind it, several models work together. It reads class material, plans each week, finds and helps with applications, keeps a live CV, and sends a weekly briefing. It runs on phone (iOS and Android) and web from a single Expo codebase, with a Next.js site.

Deadline. Official sources (Dubai Media Office, Gulf Today) say registration closes in **December 2026**, and a prototype, pitch deck and demo video are due with it. Some pages say January. **Plan to be demo-ready by mid-December.** Each Youth category winner gets **USD 150,000**. The final (first week of May 2027) needs a fully working agent shown live.

The models (verified, Oct 2026).

Job	Model	Price per 1M tokens (in / out)
Router and everyday chat	GPT-6 Luna (or Haiku 5.5)	\$0.10 / \$0.50
Heavy planning, CV and essay coaching	Claude Sonnet 5.5 (replaced Sonnet 5 on 28 Sep)	\$2 / \$10
Long notes and photos of notes	Gemini 3.1 Flash-Lite	\$0.25 / \$1.50
Hardest reasoning (rare)	GPT-6.1 Sol / Opus 5.5	\$2/\$10, \$4/\$20
Arabic and Emirati dialect	Falcon-H1-Arabic / Falcon-Emirati (self-hosted)	open weights
Gateway	LiteLLM or OpenRouter (fallbacks, providers that keep no data)	–

A realistic active student costs about **\$1.29 a month** in AI, if Sonnet calls and searches are capped and weekly jobs are batched. An uncapped heavy user can reach \$4-6.

The stack. Expo (React Native) for app and web, Next.js on Vercel (Dubai region), Supabase (Postgres + pgvector, login, storage), LangGraph.js / Vercel AI SDK, Inngest for scheduled jobs, Langfuse for monitoring, Exa/Firecrawl for opportunity crawling, Resend for email, push first with WhatsApp opt-in. Running cost is about \$50-120 a month for 100 students and \$6k-13k for 10,000.

School links. Google Classroom has a public API (needs Google verification). Teams needs each school's IT admin to approve. GEMS Phoenix has no public API, so it takes a GEMS partnership, and some GEMS schools are moving to Teams. The MVP uses photo/PDF upload plus an email-forwarding inbox, which works at every school.

Identity. UAE PASS needs a trade licence for live use, but the sandbox is free and fine for the demo. The main login is a Google or Microsoft school account.

Legal must-haves.

- The Child Digital Safety law (Decree-Law 26/2025) has been in force since Jan 2026, with about a year to comply.
- Murshid should be 13+ only, with parental consent, no ads, high-privacy defaults and a parent view.
- Leave out social posting features: under-15s are banned from social accounts.
- Follow ADEK's six AI safeguards and respect the AI-use level each school sets for a task.
- **Sam is under 18**, so a parent should hold the company (in5 at about AED 1k a year, or a DIFC AI licence at USD 1,500 a year). Sam's equity should be written down, and shares move to him on 14 Sep 2027.

How to charge: both, in this order.

1. A free pilot at Our Own High School (about 4,660 students, about 1 counsellor per 930).
2. Parents: free tier, **Plus at AED 29 a month** (or 249 a year), **Pro at AED 79**.
3. Schools: **AED 120-180 per student per year** (about AED 100 across GEMS: 45 schools, about 146k students). Pitch it as replacing both the guidance platform and the AI tutor.
4. Universities and programmes: labelled listings at AED 1.5k-5k a month. Recommendations stay unaffected, and nothing is shared without consent.
5. Government licence (about AED 50-80 per student) later, in 12-24 months.

Market. UAE has 1.277M students. Dubai private schools have 406,563, about 73.5k of them in Grades 9-12. UAE private tutoring was worth $565M in 2025.

Watch-outs.

- Abwaab already sells a planner called "Morshed", so check the name.
- Apple's developer account and Meta (WhatsApp) verification likely need an adult or a company.
- Gemini Flash prices double on 1 Jan 2027.

This week.

1. Confirm the name.
2. Send a 10-question survey to 100+ students.
3. Book 10 interviews.
4. Ask a teacher for a test Google Classroom.
5. Set up the repo (Expo + Supabase).

Murshid: Winning Playbook for the Create AI Agents Championship (Youth)

Prepared 10 Oct 2026

0. What wins here (evidence)

- **Judges reward real, personal problems.** Builder.ai's founder, who mentored the 2024 cohort: "the winners have all solved very real problems… showed unique insight." Emudy (2024 Youth winner, then App of the Year) came from the founders' own EmSAT pain and was pitched with a sized market of "an estimated 110,000 students every year." [KT]
- **The final pitch is short and public-facing.** In 2024 the finalists had **90 seconds**, and the audience voted Emudy App of the Year. [KT] Your one-line hook has to land in that time.
- **A narrow wedge with a concrete action wins.** BieBite (2025 Youth) does one thing: "scan -> allergen check -> buy." The founder told her story as a student, and the site shows a traction number ("532 beta users"). [MDX blog, biebite.com] Ettan Ehsan (2026 Youth) is "school subjects -> short gamified challenges." POP by Kwelio (2026 App of the Year) pitched behavioural science and predictive analytics, plus a **B2B2C payer (insurers)**. [Entrepreneur ME, kwelio.com]
- **Education is a crowded category** (second-largest by entries in 2025, after health), so you need sharper differentiation. [Dubai Media Office]
- **What this championship asks for:** an agent that "reasons, plans, uses tools and takes action" (more than a chatbot). You must prove customer need, business potential and measurable impact. Finalists show a **fully functional agent live, not an MVP**. The rules also say "the solution must protect personal… data and prevent information leakage." There are 24 semi-finalists and 12 finalists, and each category winner gets **USD 150,000**. [Programme page]
- **Market size:** 406,563 students in Dubai private schools in 2026-27, across 227+ schools. [Gulf Education/KHDA, KHDA]

Strategic call: keep the big "manager for every student" vision on one slide. For the January demo, lead with one wedge: **"the weekly briefing + opportunity finder that turns school notices and deadlines into a plan."** Judges back a sharp wedge with a believable roadmap over a do-everything agent.

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1. Pitch deck (13 slides)

1. **Title/hook:** "Every athlete has a manager. Now every student does." Logo, your name, "Grade 11, GEMS Our Own, Dubai."

2. **The problem, from you:** a photo of your real week: portal notices, WhatsApp groups, missed deadlines. *Collect:* how many notices or messages you get per week (count them over 2 weeks) and one opportunity you missed.
3. **The problem in numbers:** survey results (e.g., "X% missed a deadline or opportunity this term", "avg Y hrs/week organising"). *Collect:* n >= 100 survey responses and 15 interviews.
4. **Who it hurts:** the student, the parent (no visibility) and the school (low engagement with notices). Use 2 interview quotes, one each from a student and a parent.
5. **Solution:** Murshid in one sentence and 3 icons: *Knows you -> Plans for you -> Acts for you.*
6. **How the agent works:** diagram: Inputs (portal notes, calendar, goals) -> Planner (multi-model router) -> Tools (calendar, opportunity database, CV builder) -> Actions (briefing, reminders, application drafts). Show the human-approval checkpoint.
7. **Demo screenshots:** the Sunday briefing, an opportunity match, and a drafted application.
8. **Proof it works (pilot):** *Collect:* number of pilot students, weekly active %, briefings opened, deadlines met before vs after, opportunities applied to, and NPS. Include one teacher or counsellor quote.
9. **Why now / why us:** UAE AI strategy, the 406k-student market [KHDA], and the fact that you are the user.
10. **Business model:** Parents pay AED 29-49/month (test this price in the survey). Schools pay a per-student annual licence (e.g., AED 60-100). Universities or programmes could later pay for verified lead placement (opt-in). *Collect:* parent willingness to pay, and 1-2 school letters of interest.
11. **Market and scale:** TAM is UAE K-12 grades 8-12, SAM is Dubai private grades 9-12, and the SOM is 10 schools in year 1. Expansion path: GCC, then curriculum-agnostic.
12. **Competition:** a 2x2 chart, *generic ? knows the student* against *answers ? acts.* ChatGPT, school LMS, counsellor platforms and Murshid sit in the four quadrants.
13. **Trust, roadmap and ask:** privacy by design (consent, parent dashboard, no essay ghost-writing). Milestones run Jan to May, and the USD 150k goes to engineering, security and the school pilot rollout.

2. Demo video script (2:30)

- **0:00-0:15:** cold open. Phone buzzing with 14 school notices. VO: "This was my Sunday."
- **0:15-0:30:** hook line and logo. "Murshid: a personal agent that manages a student's life."
- **0:30-0:55:** onboarding. The student states goals (e.g., "engineering, UAE or UK, robotics") and Murshid builds an identity profile.
- **0:55-1:25: agent at work** (screen record). Murshid ingests portal notes, extracts 3 deadlines, books study blocks into Google Calendar and flags a clash. Show the reasoning trace ("planning -> tool call -> result") so judges see it is an agent.
- **1:25-1:50:** opportunity finder. It matches a real UAE competition or summer programme, explains why it fits, drafts the application and **waits for the student's approval**.
- **1:50-2:05:** the weekly briefing for the student and a summary for the parent (no private chats shared).
- **2:05-2:20:** pilot numbers on screen and a 5-second student testimonial.
- **2:20-2:30:** vision and close. "Built in Dubai, for every student."

3. Validation plan (Oct 2026 - Jan 2027)

- **Interviews (Oct-Nov):** 10 students across grades 9-12 and different curricula, 5 parents, 3 teachers or counsellors, and 1 school leader. Ask about the last time they missed something, how they track work today, and what they would pay for or forbid.
- **Survey (Google Form, target n >= 100):**
  1. Grade and curriculum
  2. Where you get school notices (portal, WhatsApp, email, other)
  3. In the last month, how many deadlines or tasks did you miss or nearly miss? (0 / 1-2 / 3+)
  4. Hours per week spent organising rather than studying
  5. Have you missed a competition, internship or scholarship because you found out too late? (Y/N)
  6. How confident are you about your university or career plan? (1-5)
  7. Would you let an AI read your school portal if you approve every action? (Y / Maybe / N)
  8. Most wanted feature (rank: planner, opportunities, CV, briefing, study plan)
  9. Parents only: monthly price you would consider fair (AED 0 / 19 / 39 / 59+)
  10. Email for beta access (opt-in)

- **Pilot at school (Dec-Jan):** 20-30 students for 4 weeks. Get counsellor or teacher sponsorship and parental consent forms. Students forward or paste portal notes themselves at first, so you need no system integration. Start with a 1-week baseline (no Murshid), then 3 weeks with it.
- **Metrics:** weekly active rate, briefings opened, tasks completed on time (self-reported against baseline), opportunities surfaced and applied to, time saved (self-reported), NPS, retention in week 3, and the % of parents who say they would pay.

4. Week-by-week plan (~12-15 hrs/week)

Phase A: Discover (12 Oct - 8 Nov) - W1 (12 Oct): Confirm Youth registration on the portal. Write interview guides and launch the survey. - W2 (19 Oct): Run 8 interviews and attend the Agentic AI workshop. - W3 (26 Oct): Finish interviews, push the survey to 100+ responses and analyse it. Lock the wedge. - W4 (2 Nov): Pick the stack (e.g., Next.js/Expo, Supabase, an LLM router, Google Calendar API). Wireframes. Approach the counsellor about a pilot.

Phase B: Build the MVP (9 Nov - 13 Dec) - W5: Auth, onboarding and the goal profile. - W6: Note ingestion (paste or upload) -> deadline extraction -> calendar actions. - W7: Opportunity database (seed 50 UAE opportunities by hand) and matching. - W8: Weekly briefing, plus the approval and consent layer. - W9: Internal test with 5 friends, fix bugs, privacy policy. Get pilot consent forms signed.

Phase C: Pilot and submit (14 Dec - mid-Jan) - W10-11 (term break): Run the baseline week, then launch the pilot. Draft the deck. - W12: Collect metrics mid-pilot and record the demo footage. - W13: Edit the video, finalise the deck with real numbers, and do a dry run with a teacher. - W14: **Submit early**: prototype link, deck and video. The exact January date is not yet published, so check the WhatsApp channel.

Phase D: Semi-final (late Jan - March) - Join the accelerator if selected. Add CV/portfolio and an application-draft agent. Expand the pilot to a second grade or school. Pitch in front of family and teachers 10 times, with 3-minute and 90-second versions.

Phase E: Final (April - first week of May) - Harden for a live demo: an offline fallback recording, a seeded demo account and rate-limit buffers. Run a security review. Get a school letter of intent. Over the last 2 weeks, run daily rehearsals, then freeze the code 5 days before the final.

5. Risks and judge Q&A

- **Privacy (minors' data):** "Consent-first: parent and student consent, data minimisation, encryption, no training on student data, and a delete-anything button. Every outbound action needs student approval. Aligned with UAE PDPL; school data access only via official partnership." (This also meets the championship's data-protection rule.)
- **Cheating:** "Murshid plans, finds and coaches; it does not write assessed work. Essay help is limited to feedback and outlines, and teachers can view a usage log."
- **Why not ChatGPT?** "ChatGPT waits for a prompt. Murshid already knows your timetable, goals and deadlines, then acts on them every week without being asked. It also has a curated UAE opportunity database, and the multi-model router keeps cost per student low."
- **School adoption:** "We start B2C with parents, so we don't depend on IT approvals. The pilot gives us data for schools, and schools buy because it raises engagement and improves counselling outcomes."
- **Monetisation:** "Parent subscription plus school licences. Survey: X% of parents would pay >= AED 39."
- **Execution risk (solo 17-year-old):** "Narrow MVP, open-source stack, accelerator mentorship. The grant funds a contractor for security and mobile."
- **Hallucinated opportunities:** "Every opportunity comes from a verified database with a source link. The model ranks; it doesn't invent."

Sources

- Programme page: https://www.dubaichamberdigital.com/en/create-ai-agents
- [KT] Emudy, 2024: https://www.khaleejtimes.com/uae/dubai-teenage-boys-win-app-olympics-for-platform-that-makes-education-affordable
- 2025 winners/entries: https://www.mediaoffice.ae/en/news/2025/april/16-04/hamdan-bin-mohammed-honours-winners-of-the-create-apps-championship

- BieBite: https://www.mdx.ac.ae/blogs/from-engineering-student-to-ceo-the-journey-behind-biebite ; https://biebite.com/
- 2026 winners: https://mena.entrepreneur.com/business-news/create-apps-championship-2026-winners-of-third-edition-announced-in-dubai
- Kwelio: https://kwelio.com/
- Enrolment: https://gulf.education/dubai-private-school-enrolment-406000-khda-priorities/ ; https://web.khda.gov.ae/en/Res data-statistics

Murshid: tech stack and integrations brief (researched 10 Oct 2026)

Timing first: official sources say registration closes in **December 2026**, and entries need a prototype, a pitch deck and a demo video (mediaoffice.ae/en/news/2026/october/07-10/hamdan-bin-mohammed-launches-create-ai-agents-championship; gulftoday.ae). Some timeline pages say January (veritygulf.com). Plan for a demo-ready MVP by **mid-December**.

1. Recommended stack

Layer	Pick	Why / source
App	**Expo (React Native) + Expo Router**: one codebase for iOS, Android and web/PWA	Expo SDK is free; EAS Free tier gives 15 Android + 15 iOS builds a month, and Starter is $19/mo (expo.dev/pricing, docs.expo.dev/billing/faq)
Marketing site / admin	Next.js on Vercel	Vercel has a **Dubai function region, dxb1** (vercel.com/changelog/introducing-the-dubai-vercel-region-dxb1). Pro is $20/mo per seat
DB + auth + storage + vectors	**Supabase** (Postgres + pgvector + Auth + Storage)	Pro is $25/mo and includes 100k MAU and 8 GB (supabase.com/pricing). It has **no Middle East region** (supabase.com/docs/guides/platform/regions), so use Mumbai (ap-south-1) or Frankfurt. If schools require UAE residency, move to Postgres on AWS me-central-1 (UAE)
Agent layer	TypeScript: Vercel AI SDK or LangGraph.js, with tool calls to Supabase, connectors and search APIs; a cheap model for routing (Gemini Flash-class), a stronger model for plans and CVs	Gemini 3.8 Flash costs $0.75 in / $3.75 out per 1M tokens until 31 Dec 2026, then **doubles on 1 Jan 2027** (ai.google.dev/gemini-api/docs/pricing). GPT-5.4 nano costs $0.20 / $1.25 (simonwillison.net/2026/Mar/17/mini-and-nano)
Jobs / schedulers	**Inngest** (cron, retries, step functions) or Trigger.dev	Inngest free tier: 50k-100k executions a month (sources differ); Trigger.dev bills by compute-seconds (ondelva.com, apiscout.dev)
Push	Expo Push -> APNs/FCM	Free and unlimited, capped at 600 notifications/sec (courier.com/blog/expo-notifications)
Email	Resend / Postmark (weekly briefing)	–

Layer	Pick	Why / source
WhatsApp	Meta Cloud API, used only for opt-in reminders	UAE rates from 1 Oct 2026: utility **$0.0157**, marketing $0.0576; service replies are free for the first 1,000 a month per number, then charged (purands.com/whatsapp-pricing/united-arab-emirates, chatmaxima.com). Rates exclude 5% VAT. **Needs Meta Business verification with a trade licence** (nateq.io)
Observability	**Langfuse**	Hobby is free for 50k units; Core is $29 + $8 per 100k units; self-hosting is free (langfuse.com/pricing)
Web search / scraping	Exa + Firecrawl (Tavily as an alternative)	Exa: $7 per 1k searches, $10/mo free credit. Firecrawl: 1 credit per page, $16/mo for 5k pages. Tavily: $0.008 per credit (exa.ai/pricing, docs.tavily.com/documentation/api-credits, pondero.ai)

Rough monthly cost. These are my own estimates. The model assumes about 300k input and 60k output tokens per student per month, mostly on Flash-class models, which is roughly $0.3-1 per student. Opportunity ingestion is a shared cost and doesn't grow with student numbers. - **100 students:** ~$50-120 (Supabase free or Pro, Vercel, LLM ~$30-100, everything else on free tiers). - **1,000 students:** ~$700-1,500 (LLM $300-1,000; Langfuse $29; EAS $19; search/scraping $20-80). WhatsApp adds about $270 at 4 messages a week, so make push the default channel. - **10,000 students:** ~$6k-13k (LLM $3k-9k is the main cost; Supabase compute $100-300; Inngest Pro $75+). WhatsApp would add about $2.7k, so offer it as an opt-in or premium feature only.

2. School integrations

Platform	Public API?	Access path	Notes
GEMS Phoenix Classroom (LMS) / **GEMS Connect** (parent app)	**No public API found**	Partnership with GEMS only. Phoenix signs in with Microsoft/Google (gems.phoenixclassroom.com) and is 1EdTech-certified (site.imsglobal.org), so LTI is possible through GEMS	Some GEMS schools are **moving from Phoenix to Microsoft Teams** (GEMS Legacy School circular, 2026). GEMS runs a Global Education AI Hub for pilots (gemseducation.com news, 30 Jun 2025), which is a good partnership pitch

Platform	Public API?	Access path	Notes
Google Classroom	Yes	Student scopes: `classroom.courses.readonly`, `classroom.coursework.me.readonly`, `classroom.courseworkmaterials.readonly`, `classroom.announcements.readonly` (developers.google.com/workspace/classroom/guides/auth)	Needs Google OAuth verification. Sensitive scopes take about 3-5 business days by Google's guidelines (FAQ says ~10); restricted scopes take ~6 weeks plus a security assessment (support.google.com/cloud/answer/13463817 Confirm the classification in Cloud Console. **School admins can block third-party apps**, so allow-listing is needed (developers.google.com/workspace/classr practices/access-control-enhancements)
Microsoft Teams / Education	Yes (Graph education API)	`EduAssignments.ReadBasic` (delegated)	**Requires tenant admin consent** (graphpermissions.merill.net/permission/EduAssignm learn.microsoft.com/en-us/graph/api/resources/education-overview), so each school's IT has to approve
ManageBac (IB)	Yes	School admin creates a token (client-credentials)	School-level only, not per student (help.managebac.com . . . /360018226931; guide.fariaedu.com)
Toddle	No public student API found	Uses OneRoster, Edlink, Wonde, Clever (toddleapp.com/integrations)	Partnership
iSAMS (MIS)	Yes, partners only	Paid Standard/Enterprise partner plans; the school must enable access (marketplace.isams.com/pricing)	Later stage
Arbor	Yes (REST/GraphQL), partners only	api@arbor-education.com (arbor-education.com/become-a-partner)	Mostly UK schools
Firefly	SSO API for partners	partnerships@fireflylearning.com (lantern.fireflycloud.net)	
Seesaw	Partner-only (unverified; only a third-party source)	–	Primary school, low priority
Edunation	An API page exists (edunation.net/edunation-api); terms unclear	Contact the vendor	–

Shortcut: Edlink is a single unified LMS API (ManageBac documents an Edlink flow). It's worth considering once schools sign up.

Fallback for every school, and the core of the MVP: photo or PDF upload with OCR in a vision LLM; a per-student forwarding address (e.g. `sam@in.murshid.app`) that parses LMS notification emails; share-sheet import on the phone; and ICS/calendar import.

3. Identity

- **UAE PASS:** private companies apply through the developer portal and need a **valid UAE trade licence**. The steps are questionnaire -> workflow and UI mockups -> staging credentials -> signing a Service Provider Agreement -> assessment -> go-live (docs.uaepass.ae initiation and development phases). There's a public sandbox (`sandbox_stage`) for a proof of concept (docs.uaepass.ae/quick-start-guide-uae-pass-staging-environment/testing-credentials-for-poc), which is useful for the demo.
- **Minors:** registration needs an Emirates ID and a UAE mobile number (dgov.tdra.gov.ae/services/uae-pass). I found **no official minimum age**. UAE PASS's own FAQ tells service providers to offer alternative channels for minors (docs.uaepass.ae/faq), so treat it as optional.
- **Primary sign-in:** Google and Microsoft school accounts, which also unlock the Classroom/Graph scopes. Add parent-link consent.
- **Law:** PDPL (Decree-Law 45/2021) consent rules, plus the **Child Digital Safety law (26/2025)**: under-13s need verifiable parental consent and no targeted ads (uaelegislation.gov.ae/en/legislations/3912; u.ae children's digital safety). Grade 9-12 users are mostly 14-18, but get guardian consent anyway.

4. Opportunity data

- **UAE sources:** Emirates Youth Opportunities (opportunities.youth.gov.ae; Emirati-focused), volunteers.ae, Dubai Future Foundation programmes such as TKS Dubai (dubaifuture.ae/tks-innovation-program), the MOE/ATRC Emirates Young Scientist Competition for Grades 5-12 (challengeon.atrc.ae), the UAE Space Agency's Arab Space Pioneer talent track from Grade 10 (space.gov.ae), MBRSC (mostly undergraduate, mbrsc.ae), and Dubai Chamber competitions.
- **Global sources:** Devpost, olympiad sites (IMO, IOI, etc.), MUN calendars (e.g. THIMUN), university summer programme pages.
- **Ingestion:** almost none of these have APIs or RSS. Use a curated seed list of URLs, re-crawled weekly with Firecrawl `/crawl` (with change detection) and an Exa monitor at $15 per 1k (exa.ai/pricing). An LLM extracts a fixed schema (title, eligibility, grade, nationality, deadline, cost, URL) into Postgres, vector-embeds it, deduplicates by URL plus title hash, and runs a nightly job that expires past deadlines. Student submissions are reviewed by a human before they go live.

5. CV, LinkedIn, calendar

- **CV/portfolio:** JSON Resume schema -> React-PDF or Typst templates; the portfolio is a public Next.js page per student.
- **LinkedIn:** posting as the member is **self-serve** with `w_member_social` through "Share on LinkedIn". Reading their posts (`r_member_social`) is **closed** (learn.microsoft.com/en-us/linkedin/consumer/integrations/self-serve/share-on-linkedin; learn.microsoft.com/en-us/linkedin/shared/authentication/getting-access). Third-party guides put limits at about 100 calls per member per day, with 60-day tokens (unofficial). Draft posts and have the student approve each one. LinkedIn's minimum age is 16.
- **Calendar:** Google Calendar API (`calendar.events` is a sensitive scope), Microsoft Graph `Calendars.ReadWrite`, and an ICS subscription feed for Apple.

6. Architecture and build order

Data flow in words: the Expo app (iOS, Android, web) sends requests through Supabase Auth (Google/Microsoft) to Supabase Postgres, which holds the profile, goals, courses, tasks, opportunities, embeddings and CV. The agent API (Vercel, dxb1) calls the LLMs, the search tools and the connectors. Inngest crons run ingestion, the weekly briefing, reminders and deadline sweeps. Output goes to Expo Push, email and opt-in WhatsApp. Langfuse traces every agent call.

MVP by mid-December 2026: 1. Onboarding (identity, goals, grade, interests) 2. Upload/forward ingestion and a study plan 3. Opportunity finder over a curated 50-100 sources 4. CV builder -> PDF 5. Weekly briefing and push reminders 6. Google Classroom read-only in Testing mode (up to 100 test users is fine for a demo) 7. UAE PASS sandbox login as a "partnership-ready" demo

Later (2027): verified Google app, Microsoft Teams with school admin consent, the GEMS partnership or LTI, ManageBac tokens per school, production UAE PASS (needs a trade licence, e.g. through a parent's company or a

free-zone/youth licence), WhatsApp (Meta verification), the LinkedIn auto-post flow, application auto-fill, Arabic UI, and UAE data residency.

Practical blockers for a 17-year-old founder (unverified, not fetched): Apple's developer program, Meta Business verification and UAE PASS all expect an adult or a licensed entity. A parent or guardian entity is the usual workaround.

Murshid: the AI model layer (researched 10 Oct 2026)

0. Checking the founder's model names

- **"GPT-6 Luna" is real.** OpenAI released it on 22 Sep 2026 as the cheapest GPT-6 model. API ID: `gpt-6-luna`. Price: $0.10 input / $0.50 output per million tokens. Context window: 1.05M tokens. Sources: openai.com/index/introducing-gpt-6-sol-and-luna/, docs.aws.amazon.com/bedrock/latest/userguide/model-card-openai-gpt-6-luna.html
- **"Sonnet 5" is real but no longer the newest.** Claude Sonnet 5 (`claude-sonnet-5`) came out on 30 Jun 2026. **Claude Sonnet 5.5** (`claude-sonnet-5-5`) replaced it on 28 Sep 2026 at the same $2/$10 price. Use Sonnet 5.5. Sources: anthropic.com/news/claude-sonnet-5, anthropic.com/claude-sonnet-5-5

1. Models available as of Oct 2026 (USD per million tokens, input/output)

Model	Best for	Context	Price
OpenAI GPT-6 Astra	Top quality across the board	not checked	$10 / $50
OpenAI GPT-6.1 Sol	Everyday hard work, agents	1M (long-context pricing applies)	$2 / $10 (cached input $0.10)
OpenAI GPT-6 Luna	Cheap, high-volume work, routing, extraction	1.05M	$0.10 / $0.50 (cached input $0.01)
Anthropic Claude Fable 5.1	Hardest reasoning and long agent tasks	1M	$10 / $50
Anthropic Claude Opus 5.5	Long agentic and knowledge work	1M	$4 / $20
Anthropic Claude Sonnet 5.5	Speed plus intelligence; strong writing	1M	$2 / $10 (cache hit $0.10)
Anthropic Claude Haiku 5.5	Classification and routing	not checked	$0.10 / $0.50 for prompts up to 100k tokens; $0.50 / $2.50 above that
Google Gemini 4 Argon	Frontier model, announced 30 Sep	1M (reported)	$2 / $10 introductory, then $4 / $20. **Not public in the API yet.**
Google Gemini 3.1 Pro (preview)	Multimodal reasoning	not checked	$2 / $12
Google Gemini 3.8 Flash	Agents; takes text, image, audio and video	about 1M	$0.75 / $3.75 until 31 Dec, then $1.50 / $7.50
Google Gemini 3.1 Flash-Lite	Cheap multimodal work, OCR	about 1M	$0.25 / $1.50
DeepSeek V4.1-Flash (open weights)	Cheap reasoning, vision	1M	$0.30 / $1.20 at peak; half that off-peak
DeepSeek V4-Pro (open weights, MIT licence)	Strong open model	1M	$1.32 / $3.96 at peak
Mistral Large 4 (open weights due 31 Oct)	EU-hosted option	not checked	$1.36 / $4.18 list ($0.68 / $2.09 launch promo)*
Qwen3.8-27B / Llama 4 Maverick	Self-hosted or cheap hosted	1M / not checked	about $0.05 / $0.90 and about $0.20 / $0.70*

Model	Best for	Context	Price
Falcon-H1-Arabic 3B/7B/34B (TII); Falcon-Emirati-7B (6 Oct 2026)	Best open Arabic models; Emirati dialect	128k-256k	Free weights (Falcon licence); you pay for your own hosting
Jais 2 8B/70B (Inception/MBZUAI/Cerebras)	Arabic-first, permissive licence	not checked	Open weights; also in the Azure catalog
Seraj (Inception42 + Microsoft, built on GPT-4.1)	Arabic for enterprise, served in the UAE	not checked	Through Core42 Compass; price not published

*Taken from search excerpts and third-party trackers, not from a fetched vendor page.

Pages fetched: platform.claude.com/docs/en/about-claude/pricing - developers.openai.com/api/docs/pricing - ai.google.dev/gemini-api/docs/pricing (updated 9 Oct) - api-docs.deepseek.com/quick_start/pricing - blog.google/.../gemini-4-argon (excerpt). Arabic models: tii.ae (Falcon-H1 Arabic, 5 Jan 2026), huggingface.co/blog/tiiuae/falcon-emirati, arxiv.org/abs/2608.13580 (Jais 2), wam.ae (Seraj, 2 Jul 2026).

Two pricing traps: - Claude 4.7 and later use a new tokenizer that produces about 30% more tokens for the same text. - Gemini 3.8 Flash's price doubles on 1 Jan 2027.

2. Routing design

How a request flows 1. Client sends the request. 2. Rules run first, at no model cost: intent keywords, attachment type, language detection, and the student's remaining budget. 3. The router model handles anything the rules can't settle. Use GPT-6 Luna or Haiku 5.5 with structured JSON output: {task, complexity, language, needs_web}. 4. The chosen task model runs. 5. A moderation and integrity check runs on both input and output.

Which model does which job | Job | Main model | Fallback | |—|—|—| | Router / classifier | GPT-6 Luna | Haiku 5.5 | | Everyday chat, reminders, portal-note summaries | GPT-6 Luna | Gemini 3.1 Flash-Lite | | Heavy planning (study plans, application strategy, weekly briefing) | Claude Sonnet 5.5; briefings run overnight through the Batch API at 50% off | GPT-6.1 Sol | | Long class notes or PDFs | Gemini 3.1 Flash-Lite, or Luna (1M context) | Sonnet 5.5 for synthesis | | Web research and opportunity finding | Luna to plan and summarise, plus a search tool (OpenAI web search is $10 per 1,000 calls; Gemini grounding gives 5,000 free searches a month across the whole project, then $14 per 1,000) | – | | CV, essays, LinkedIn outreach (coaching only) | Sonnet 5.5 | GPT-6.1 Sol | | Arabic | Frontier models for Modern Standard Arabic | Falcon-H1-Arabic or Falcon-Emirati, self-hosted in the UAE, for dialect and sovereign data | | Embeddings | Gemini Embedding 2 ($0.20) | OpenAI text-embedding-3-large (can be processed in the UAE) | | Voice | gpt-transcribe ($0.0045/min) for speech-to-text; Gemini 3.8 Flash-Lite TTS (about $0.009/min) for speech; GPT-Live ($0.05/min) only for premium live voice | – | | Vision (photos of notes) | Gemini 3.1 Flash-Lite | Falcon-OCR-Arabic for Arabic handwriting |

Controls - Keep a per-student token ledger. At 80% of the monthly cap, drop to the cheap tier. - Cap heavy calls at about 10 per month. - Cache system prompts and student profiles. Cache reads cost 90-97.5% less than normal input. - Fall back in a fixed order across providers when one returns 429 or 5xx. - Cap output length.

Framework stack - **LiteLLM** (self-hosted proxy) or **OpenRouter** as the single gateway. OpenRouter adds model fallbacks, ZDR-only routing per request (`provider.zdr`), and in-region routing (openrouter.ai/docs/features/zdr). - **Vercel AI SDK** for streaming to web and mobile. - **LangGraph** for durable multi-step flows such as application pipelines and the weekly briefing. - **MCP servers** for the school portal, calendar, Gmail and LinkedIn tools. - The OpenAI Agents SDK or Claude Agent SDK only if you commit to one vendor. Prefer neutral orchestration.

3. Cost per active student per month

Assumptions per student per month: - 250 chat turns at about 6k input tokens (60% cached) and 500 output tokens - 300 router calls - 8 heavy planning calls, 4 batched weekly briefings, 6 CV/essay sessions - 10 long documents of about 30k tokens each, 30 photos - 15 web searches - 300k tokens embedded - 30 minutes of speech-to-text, 10 minutes of text-to-speech

Item	Cost
Router	$0.03
Chat	$0.13
Heavy planning	$0.33
Briefings	$0.08
CV/essays	$0.14
Documents	$0.10
Photos	$0.03
Research	$0.02
Search fees	$0.15
Embeddings	$0.06
Speech-to-text	$0.14
Text-to-speech	$0.09
Total	**about $1.29**

The calculator is at `/workspace/work/murshid_cost.py`.

Keeping it under $1-2 - Sonnet calls and search fees are about half the bill. Cap both. - Batch every scheduled job (briefings, opportunity scans): 50% off. - Run DeepSeek V4-Flash jobs off-peak. - Use caching aggressively. - Make live voice a paid add-on. - A heavy user without caps could reach $4-6.

4. Safety for minors and data

OpenAI's under-18 guidance (developers.openai.com/api/docs/guides/safety-checks/under-18-api-guidance): - Age-appropriate content filters. - Monitoring with escalation paths. - Age assurance where needed. - Use current flagship models. - **Don't process personal data of children under 13 (or below the local age of digital consent) without Zero Data Retention.**

Moderation - OpenAI `omni-moderation-latest`: no retention and eligible for ZDR (price not shown on the fetched page). - Gemini safety settings. - OpenRouter custom classifiers and guardrails.

Academic integrity - Use a separate "integrity classifier" step: is this a graded assignment? - In tutor mode, respond with hints, Socratic questions and outlines instead of finished answers. - For essays and CVs, give feedback and suggest edits on the student's own draft. Never ghost-write from nothing. - Log what help was given so parents and teachers can see it.

Data retention - **OpenAI:** abuse logs kept 30 days by default. ZDR or Modified Abuse Monitoring needs approval. Image inputs flagged as CSAM are kept even under ZDR. (developers.openai.com/api/docs/guides/your-data) - **Anthropic:** ZDR by approval for each organisation. Safety-classifier results are still kept. (privacy.claude.com) - **Gemini:** paid tier doesn't use content for training. Free tier does, so keep it out of production.

Regional hosting - **OpenAI** offers a UAE data residency endpoint, `ae.api.openai.com`. It requires MAM or ZDR plus extra approval. Inference stays in the UAE only for `gpt-5.6-luna`, `gpt-5.5`, `gpt-5.2` and `text-embedding-3-large`. **GPT-6 models are stored in the UAE but processed elsewhere.** There is a 10% price uplift. - **AWS Bedrock me-central-1 (UAE):** Claude 4.5/4.6 available. Profiles labelled `global.*` route out of the country; use regional model IDs (azrty.com, 1 Oct 2026; aws.amazon.com blog, Feb 2026). - **Azure UAE North:** GPT-5.x only on Global deployments, which can process anywhere. Regional Provisioned covers gpt-4.1, gpt-5-mini and gpt-5.1 (10n.tech, Sep 2026). - **Google:** regions in Doha (me-central1) and Dammam (me-central2, KSA customers only, through CNTXT). No UAE region. - **Core42 Compass:** serves DeepSeek V4 Pro, GLM-5.2, K2, Mistral Small and Seraj in the UAE (core42.ai/compass/documentation/compass-models).

Recommendation: start global with ZDR applied for. Keep all student records (the database and embeddings) in a UAE region. Move to UAE-processed models such as Bedrock regional Claude, `ae.api` GPT-5.6 Luna or self-hosted Falcon when schools ask for in-country processing.

Gaps

- Not verified: Haiku 5.5 and GPT-6 Astra context windows, OpenAI embedding and moderation prices, and a public date for Gemini 4 Argon.
- Qwen, Llama and Mistral prices come from search excerpts only.
- UAE privacy law (PDPL) consent rules for minors were not researched.

Murshid: market, competitors and business model (as of 10 Oct 2026)

Short answer: Sell to both, in a set order. Don't start with B2C alone or B2B alone. 1. **Now:** run a free pilot at Our Own High School (OOW). Universities and programmes pay for clearly labelled listings, the way BridgeU works. 2. **Revenue proof by Jan 2027:** a paid parent tier (freemium). 3. **2027-28:** a per-student school licence sold through GEMS. 4. **Later:** a government (B2G) licence, following Alef Education's path.

The reasons: schools already get guidance software free or cheap; parents already spend heavily on tutoring; and universities already pay to reach counsellors and students.

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1. Market size

Metric	Figure	Source
UAE students, 2026-27	**1.277M** in 1,180+ schools	https://www.wam.ae/en/article/c1xfv5i-ministry-education-announces-readiness-education
Private vs public (early 2026)	~793k private vs ~287k public. Dubai is >90% private	https://opportunities-insight.britishcouncil.org/download/data/50336/22
Dubai private (KHDA), 2026-27	**406,563** students (up 4.6%). 2024-25: 387,441 in 227 schools	https://gulf.education/dubai-private-school-enrolment-406000-khda-priorities/ ; https://web.khda.gov.ae/en/About-Us/News/2025/Dubais-private-school-sector-records-6-enrolment
Dubai Grades 9-12	**~70,100 in 2024-25 (18.1%). About 73,500 in 2026-27 (estimate)**	KHDA landscape chart, by grade. My reading: G9 22,381 / G10 19,430 / G11 17,047 / G12 11,241. The 15 bars add up exactly to 387,441. https://web.khda.gov.ae/getattachment/Resources-and-Statistics/Dubai-private-school-landscape-2024-2025/Dubai-Private-School-Landsacpe-Ar.pdf.aspx
UAE Grades 9-12	~**200-230k (estimate**, using Dubai's 18% share)	derived
Curricula (Dubai)	UK 37%, Indian 26%, US 14%, IB 7%, UK/IB 4%	https://mediaoffice.ae/en/news/2025/january/09-01/dubais-private-school-sector
Dubai fees	Median top-year tuition **AED 63,750** (range 9,250-161,000). Average starting fee AED 33,665. Sector revenue over USD 4bn	https://international-schools-guide.com/insights/international-school-fees-dubai/ ; https://www.dxbschools.com/dubai-school-fees-index-2026 ; KHDA investment PDF
Tutoring	UAE market **USD 565M (2025)**: 18.6M paid hours, ~405k learners. IB/A-Level tutoring costs **AED 200-380/hr**, premium AED 300-500+	https://www.kenresearch.com/industry-reports/uae-private-tutoring-market ; https://privatetutorsindubai.ae/private-tutor-cost-dubai-guide

Metric	Figure	Source
Counselling	Crimson multi-year packages run **USD 25k-65k+**, per third-party reports. Crimson doesn't publish prices. Low-cost peer counselling (Mentra) costs USD 800-1,000	https://www.findmyorbit.com/blog/is-crimson-worth-it ; https://www.edarabia.com/dh1100-dh3600-uae-student-makes-ivy-league-admissions-affordable
TutorBin	Pay per task, roughly USD 10-30+. No subscription	https://helpacads.com/tutorbin-reviews-alternatives/
The Edvisor	**A teacher-training and school consultancy (Dubai), not a student counsellor.** It publishes no student pricing	https://the-edvisor.com/
GCC	14.0M -> 15.5M students (2024-29). K-12 reaches 12.9M, of which 3.8M are private. Saudi Arabia will hold ~65% of enrolment	https://alpencapital.com/wp-content/uploads/2025/05/GCC-Education-Industry-Report_2025.pdf

Price fit at OOW: OOW is a low-fee CBSE school. Tuition is AED 7,828-16,299 a year (https://talem.ae/institution/gems-our-own-high-school-al-warqa/fees), and it has ~4,660 students with **5 counsellors**, about 1 per 930 students (https://edcare.ae/schools/our-own-high-school/fees). The counsellor shortage is a strong pain point. But B2C prices must suit families at this fee level.

2. Competitors and pricing

Player	Schools pay	Parents/students pay	Notes
BridgeU (Kaplan)	**Free**. Universities fund it	–	1,000+ schools. Shows a university-funded model works (https://bridge-u.com/resources/frequently-asked-questions/)
Cialfo	From ~USD 3,500/school/yr	–	Used in UAE schools. Direct Apply to 1,200+ universities (https://edtechimpact.com/products/cia
Unifrog	Quote only. Add-on packs GBP 350/yr	–	4,000+ schools (unifrog.org)
Naviance	USD 4.7-7.7/student (DC contract)	–	https://dcps.dc.gov/...PowerSchool_Fu Signed.pdf
Xello	USD 3.6-4.95/student	–	Kansas quote (BoardDocs)
MaiaLearning	~USD 5-25/student (third-party estimate)	–	eathealthy365.com
Univariety / CollegeAI	Quote only / free	–	India-centric / free matching
Crimson	–	USD 25k-100k+	Has a Dubai office (DIFC)
Khanmigo	**USD 10/student/yr** (US)	USD 4/mo (US-only billing)	https://www.khanacademy.org/schools/ ; https://khanmigo.ai/pricing
ChatGPT	Edu is for universities (~USD 156+/user/yr). Teachers plan free (US)	Free, includes study mode	https://openai.com/index/chatgpt-study-mode/
Gemini for Education	Free with Google Workspace for Education	Free	https://edu.google.com/ai/gemini-for-education/

Player	Schools pay	Parents/students pay	Notes
Alef Education	B2G/B2B: 183 private schools, 122k paying students, revenue AED 769.5M (FY25)	–	https://www.alefeducation.com/global-presence
Abwaab	–	~SAR 95/grade package. A study-planner add-on called "Morshed" (the same Arabic word as Murshid) is sold for about USD 35-41	App Store. **Possible name clash: check the trademark**
Noon Academy	–	Noon Plus ~SAR 118-295	App Store (SA)
BYJU'S/Toppr	–	~USD 150/yr (India)	Weakened brand
MyStudyLife	–	Free. MSL+ USD 6.99/mo or 39.99/yr	App Store
Notion	–	Free Education plan is for **university students only**; K-12 students don't qualify	notion.com

The gap Murshid fills: these tools are split three ways. Guidance platforms serve the counsellor and the application. AI tutors serve subjects. Planners handle tasks. None of them acts as a single "manager": one agent that holds a student's goals, notes, study plan, opportunity search, applications, CV/portfolio and LinkedIn presence, and that also reports to parents. Local players (Alef, Abwaab, Noon) focus on curriculum.

3. Recommended pricing (all figures are estimates)

- **B2C freemium:** Free tier covers goals, a planner, and limited AI.
  - **Plus: AED 29/mo or AED 249/yr.** Gross margin ~70-77% at USD 1.5 of AI cost a month.
  - **Pro (application season): AED 79/mo or AED 699/yr.** Includes CV/portfolio, application tracking, and one human review a term. Margin ~85-90% before the human review.
  - Plus costs about what one hour of tutoring costs in a whole year.
- **B2B (Grades 9-12): list price AED 120-180/student/yr. GEMS group price ~AED 100.**
  - **Warning:** at Naviance-like prices (AED 75), gross margin is only ~23% with USD 1.5/month AI cost over 10 months. At AED 150 it is ~61%.
  - So either sell Murshid as replacing two tools (a guidance platform plus an AI tutor), or bring model cost under USD 0.75/month by sending simple requests to cheaper models.
- **B2G (KHDA/MoE/ADEK):** about AED 50-80/student at scale, plus a fixed fee to adapt it to local requirements. Alef's ADEK contract (renewed to 2033) shows this route can work, but it takes 12-24 months.
- **University and programme partners:**
  - Labelled "featured" listings at AED 1,500-5,000/month. For comparison, one listing platform charges AED 500/month for a founding sponsor (https://www.vistabylara.com/ai-tools/university-pathway-planner/comparison).
  - Plus **AED 50-200 per enquiry that a parent has agreed to share**.
  - Universities already pay **USD 4,400** for 26 meetings with Gulf counsellors (https://bmiglobaled.com/recruit-students/gulf-india-counsellor-workshop).
  - Rules: paid placement must never change Murshid's recommendations, and no student data is shared without parental consent (UAE data-protection law covers minors).
- **Unit economics (estimates):**
  - Freemium conversion: 3-5%.
  - Acquisition cost for each paying parent: AED 60-150, through ambassadors and short-video content.
  - Plus subscriber lifetime value: about 9 months x AED 29 x 75% margin ~ **AED 195**. That gives an LTV/CAC of roughly 1.3-3x. Annual plans and the Pro tier lift it.
  - School example: 1,300 Grade 9-12 students x AED 100 = **AED 130k a year**, with a sales cycle of 3-9 months.

4. Go-to-market (Oct 2026 -> Jan 2027)

- **Oct:** Get the principal and counsellors to approve. Sign parental consent forms. Run a beta with 30 Grade 11-12 students at OOW.
- **Nov:** Widen to a 150-300 student pilot (Grades 9-12). Recruit 10 student ambassadors with referral codes. Post 3 Instagram/TikTok videos a week (study plans, finding opportunities, before/after CVs).
- **Dec:** Launch paid Plus. Pitch GEMS central (45 UAE schools, ~146k students: https://gulfbusiness.com/en/2026/education-industry/dubais-gems-sees-dip-in-uae-school-registrations-but-growth-plans-intact/). Get letters of intent from 2-3 Dubai branch campuses or summer programmes.
- **Counsellor networks:**
  - UAE Counselor's WhatsApp group (contact list in the THE database: https://www.timeshighereducation.com/cms-academic/sites/default/files/2024-02/Counselor%20%26%20University%20Support%20Database.pdf)
  - International ACAC MENA Regional Institute
  - THE/BMI Gulf & India Counsellor Workshop
  - ADEK Counselors Forum
- **Jan 2027 metrics for judges:**
  - Number of active pilot users, plus 4-week retention above 40%
  - Number of study plans and CVs created
  - Opportunities matched and applications submitted
  - Counsellor hours saved, from a survey
  - Parent NPS
  - Paid conversion %
  - Signed school or university letters of intent
  - AI cost per active student (target under USD 1)

Gaps: KHDA hasn't published a 2025-26 Grade 9-12 split (2024-25 is the latest). Crimson, Unifrog, Cialfo, BridgeU-for-universities and Univariety publish no full pricing. GCC and tutoring market figures come from analyst reports.

Murshid: legal, compliance and partnership brief (as of 10 Oct 2026)

Murshid is a personal AI agent for UAE students aged about 13 to 18. It holds identity details, grades, class notes, goals and CVs, and may connect to school portals and parents. This brief is not legal advice. (!) marks a point that is uncertain or that I could not verify.

1. Data protection

- **Federal PDPL (Decree-Law 45/2021).** It has been in force since 2 Jan 2022 and covers mainland firms, plus foreign firms that process data of people in the UAE.
  - Consent is the default basis: it must be provable and easy to withdraw (Arts 4 and 6). There is no "legitimate interests" basis.
  - Other duties: a DPO for high-risk or profiling-heavy processing (Art 10), breach notice to the Data Office (Art 9), and a DPIA for high-risk new technology (Art 21).
  - **The Executive Regulations and the penalties decision have still not been issued.** The six-month grace period only starts once they are. https://trytrustable.com/uae-pdpl
  - In June 2026 the UAE created a Federal Authority for AI and Data, which absorbs the Data Office's functions. It is expected to take over PDPL enforcement (!). https://www.morganlewis.com/pubs/2026/06/uae-establishes-federal-authority-for-artificial-intelligence-and-data
- **Children's data: the Child Digital Safety Law (Decree-Law 26/2025) is the binding rule.** This is the law that matters most for Murshid.
  - Effective 1 Jan 2026, with one year to comply, so about Jan 2027. It reaches any app that operates in or targets the UAE.
  - **No collecting data from under-13s without verified parental consent.** No advertising use of children's data. Parents must be able to withdraw consent easily.
  - Platforms need age verification, high-privacy default settings and parental tools, all scaled to a risk classification the Cabinet has yet to publish. https://www.lexismiddleeast.com/pn/UnitedArabEmirates/UAE_Federal_Decree_Law_No._26_2025_on_Child_Digital_Safety/en - https://uaelegislation.gov.ae/en/legislations/3912

- https://www.lw.com/en/insights/uaes-child-digital-safety-law-what-every-digital-platform-and-isp-should-know
  - **Cabinet Resolution 106/2026** bars social-media accounts for under-15s and rules out self-declared age. Keep Murshid free of social or posting features so it stays outside this resolution (!). https://uaelegislation.gov.ae/en/legislations/4506
- **Cross-border transfers and residency.**
  - Transfers are allowed to "adequate" countries (Art 22). Otherwise they need a contract, explicit consent and the other Art 23 grounds.
  - There is no blanket localisation rule. Still, hosting in the UAE (Azure UAE North, AWS me-central-1, G42/Core42) is the easiest thing to defend to schools and government.
- **DIFC and ADGM.** A company set up in DIFC (for example under the AI licence below) falls under DIFC Data Protection Law 5/2020 instead of the PDPL. ADGM has its own 2021 regulations. https://trytrustable.com/uae-pdpl
- **Dubai-specific rules.** I found none for private edtech beyond federal law and KHDA (!).

2. Education regulators and AI-in-schools rules

- **KHDA (Dubai private schools).**
  - On 1 Oct 2026 KHDA said it is drafting an AI and technology policy, expected in force for **2027-28**. It will be age and stage based and cover safeguards and the role of parents.
  - KHDA will **not prescribe platforms**. It will set safeguards that schools must check before adopting one. https://www.thenationalnews.com/news/uae/2026/10/01/dubai-schools-to-receive-new-rules-on-ai-use-for-children-next-year/
  - (!) I found **no public KHDA edtech approval or procurement process, and no edtech sandbox**. Individual schools vet their own vendors. Dubai Future Foundation runs Sandbox Dubai (sandboxdubai.gov.ae), but I have not verified whether it fits Murshid.
- **ADEK (Abu Dhabi), the best template to build to now.**
  - Its Technology and AI Policy requires schools to use AI tools that "meet ADEK requirements".
  - Safeguards cover six areas: data protection, cognitive agency, academic integrity, human oversight, content safety and fit with UAE values, and algorithmic fairness. https://www.adek.gov.ae/MediaCentre/News/ADEK-Advances-AI-Literacy-Initiative-across-170-Private-Schools
  - (!) From policy excerpts I did not read in full:
    - The ADEK Digital Policy vets vendors on security and PDPL compliance.
    - The ADEK Assessment Policy bars sharing student assessment data with third parties without parental consent and ADEK approval.
- **MoE.**
  - AI is a K-12 subject in public schools from 2025-26 (https://www.wam.ae/en/article/bji6z2n-ministry-education-introduces-curriculum-public).
  - The Cabinet extended the curriculum to **all public and private schools** in Sept 2026 and plans to train 22,000 teachers (https://www.thenationalnews.com/news/uae/2026/09/02/sheikh-mohammed-bin-rashid-announces-ai-curriculum-for-all-schools-in-uae/).
  - The K-12 framework is at https://www.moe.gov.ae/en/pages/ai.aspx. Positioning Murshid as support for AI literacy and career readiness lines it up with these goals.

3. App stores and international users

- **Apple.**
  - Guideline 5.1.4: an app collecting minors' data needs a privacy policy and must comply with COPPA and GDPR.
  - Guideline 5.1.2(i): **sharing data with a third-party AI must be clearly disclosed, with explicit permission.**
  - Account deletion must be available in the app (5.1.1(v)).
  - Do not market Murshid "for kids" unless it is in the Kids Category (2.3.8). https://developer.apple.com/app-store/review/guidelines/
- **Google Play.**
  - Declare 13-15 and 16-17 as target ages.

  - If any target age group counts as children, the Families policy applies (certified ad SDKs only, a neutral age screen).
  - Google warns that users under 21 may be "children" under local law.
  - The Play Age Signals API currently returns age signals only in Brazil and some US states. https://support.google.com/googleplay/android-developer/answer/9867159 - https://developer.android.com/google/pla signals/overview
- **COPPA (US, under 13).** The amended rule has been enforceable since **22 Apr 2026**. It requires separate parental consent before disclosing data to third parties and sets data-retention limits. https://www.federalregister.gov/documents/2025/04/22/2025-05904/childrens-online-privacy-protection-rule
- **GDPR Art 8 (EU).** Parental consent is needed below age 16 (member states may lower it to 13) and must be verified with "reasonable efforts". https://gdpr-info.eu/art-8-gdpr/
- **Design recommendation.**
  - Launch at 13+ only.
  - Neutral age screen, then parent verification for anyone under 18. UAE PASS or Emirates ID verification is best; a parent account co-signs.
  - A parent dashboard where parents can withdraw consent.
  - No ads and no data sale.
  - LLM provider set to zero retention and no training on user data, disclosed to users.

4. Company setup for a 17-year-old

- **The law.**
  - The age to trade is 18 (Commercial Transactions Law 50/2022, Art 18.1).
  - A 15-17-year-old may trade only under conditions set by a Cabinet resolution (Art 18.2). (!) I could not find that resolution.
  - Full civil majority at 18 started on 1 Jun 2026 (Civil Transactions Law 25/2025). https://lylawyers.com/blog/understand the-new-age-requirements-for-business-ownership-in-the-uae
- **Practical path.**
  - A parent holds the licence or shares now, with a written agreement or side letter on the founder's equity and IP. Shares transfer once the founder turns 18.
  - Until then, keep Murshid as a non-commercial prototype under the founder's name. The championship accepts ideas and prototypes, so no company is needed yet.
- **Options and approximate costs.**
  - **in5 Tech (Dubai Internet City, DDA FZ-LLC):** about AED 1,000 a year licence for 3 years, plus a co-working desk at about AED 15k in year 1. Entry is by committee. https://www.dxbstart.com/licensing/dubai-internet-city (the official infive.ae page was bot-blocked (!))
  - **DIFC AI Licence:** USD 1,500 a year, with co-working included and DIFC data law applying. https://www.difc.com/business/establish-a-business/ai-licence
  - **Hub71 (Abu Dhabi):** requires relocating to Abu Dhabi and gives equity through a SAFE. A poor fit now.
  - DSO/DTEC "student rate" of about AED 4k comes from one unofficial source (!).
- **No Dubai "student entrepreneur licence" found.**
  - Abu Dhabi's Future Entrepreneurs permit (ages 4-18) covers only exhibition and retail activities, not software. https://www.adra.gov.ae/en/media-centre/news/ADRA-launches-Future-Entrepreneurs-permit
  - Dubai Next crowdfunding allows pitches from age 12 with guardian approval (per LYLAW above).

5. Partnership and funding paths, most relevant first

1. **Create AI Agents Championship, Youth category.** Lead applicant must be under 21. The category winner gets USD 150k; the AI Agent of the Year gets AED 1M. The top 24 entries join a Tech Accelerator, and the final is a pitch to government leaders.
   - Rules require the solution to "protect personal... data and prevent information leakage."
   - Registration closes Dec 2026 or Jan 2027 (official pages differ). https://www.dubaichamberdigital.com/en/create-ai-agents
2. **GEMS (the founder's school group).**

- **Next Billion Innovation fund:** USD 1M for student ventures, run through the GEMS Global Innovation Challenge. https://www.gemseducation.com/en/News-and-Events/News/GEMS-Education-launches-Next-Billion-Innovation-startup-fund-for-future-creators-and-entrepreneurs
- **Global Education AI Hub:** invites edtech startups; its test bed is GEMS School of Research & Innovation. https://www.gemseducation.com/en/News-and-Events/News/GEMS-Global-Education-AI-Hub-launched-to-transform-the-future-of-learning
- This is the most realistic first school pilot.

3. **MBRIF Accelerator (Ministry of Finance).** No age or nationality limit, no equity taken, education is a priority sector. It needs a working prototype and gives no cash. The Innovation Trailblazers stream is for university students only. https://mbrif.ae/faq-2/
4. **Dubai Future Foundation / DCAI Agentic AI for Government Services Accelerator.** For AI companies building government-facing agents, with priority to Dubai AI Seal holders. It becomes relevant once there is a company. https://www.dubaifuture.ae/dcai-accelerators/
5. **Dubai AI Campus (DIFC)** for its programmes and licence, and **KHDA-INJAZ** student entrepreneurship programmes for visibility (https://web.khda.gov.ae/en/About-Us/News/2025/KHDA-and-INJAZ-UAE-partner-to-promote-entrepreneur). (!) KHDA's "What Works" is a forum where educators share practice, not an edtech pilot channel.

6. What schools will demand

- **Academic integrity.**
  - Dubai schools already use tiered AI-use levels: L0 means no AI, L1 means AI support, L2 means AI-led (Nord Anglia). CIS uses a colour-coded scale.
  - The red line is AI producing the substantive work that is submitted. https://whichschooladvisor.com/uae/school-news/ai-homework-essays-and-chatgpt-what-dubai-schools-actually-allow
  - Murshid should:
    - respect each task's AI level;
    - coach rather than write;
    - log how AI was used so students can disclose it;
    - never auto-complete assessed work.
- **AI safety.** Map Murshid to ADEK's six safeguards. Add:
  - content filtering suited to UAE values;
  - escalation to a safeguarding lead;
  - no decisions without human review (PDPL Art 18 lets users object to automated decisions);
  - read-only portal access with the school's sign-off;
  - a DPIA, a DPO contact and a breach plan;
  - parental visibility.

Biggest open gaps: - Missing PDPL Executive Regulations. - The unpublished risk classification under the Child Digital Safety law. - KHDA's AI policy, due in 2027. - The Cabinet resolution on 15-17-year-olds trading.